

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Disgraced ex-speaker sentenced to 90 months in prison after judge excoriates him for lying on stand

83-year-old Democrat says 'I am not perfect,' but stops short of admitting guilt on multiple corruption charges

Court levies maximum \$2.5M fine on long-serving machine politician for 'abuse of power at the highest level'

7-PLUS YEARS FOR 'CORRUPT' MADIGAN



Former Illinois House Speaker Michael Madigan leaves the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse after being sentenced to prison Friday in Chicago. AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

By Jason Meisner and Ray Long
Chicago Tribune

Michael J. Madigan spent decades as speaker of the Illinois House, but when he strode to the lectern in a packed federal courtroom on Friday he seemed almost unsure of what to say.

Pausing to sip from a bottle of water and clear his throat, Madigan, 83, wiped his face with a handkerchief before he began

to talk in a thin voice, reading initially from what appeared to be a page of notes in front of him.

"I am truly sorry for putting the people of the state of Illinois through this," Madigan told U.S. District Judge John Robert Blakey near the end of his three-and-a-half-hour sentencing hearing on corruption charges. "I tried to do my best to serve the people of the state of Illinois. I am not perfect."

Gesturing with his right hand as he spoke, Madigan stopped far

short of admitting guilt. But he did ask for leniency, saying he needed to spend his "remaining days" at home taking care of his ailing wife, Shirley.

"When I look back on my life, being speaker is not what gives me the most pride," Madigan said as two of his daughters and several other relatives looked on from the front row of the courtroom gallery. "I am most proud of being a good husband, a good father and now a good grandfather."

Moments later, however, Blakey erased any hope of probation for Madigan, sentencing the onetime state Democratic leader to seven and a half years in federal prison for his conviction on corruption charges alleging he used his public office to amass power, boost business for his private law firm and enrich a small circle of his most loyal associates.

In handing down the 90-month

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What's next

Under federal rules, former Illinois House Speaker Michael Madigan must serve at least 85% of the sentence, which, with good behavior amounts to about six years and three months behind bars. Madigan was told to report to prison Oct. 13, though his lawyers said they plan to file for a bond to keep him out of jail while any appeal is pending.

Clearer path nears for gun offenders to buy firearms

By Jeremy Gorner
Chicago Tribune

On the final day of the spring legislative session, the Democratic-led Illinois General Assembly passed a measure intended to make it easier for people who have been arrested for carrying guns illegally to obtain a state firearm permit so they would be allowed to own firearms.

The bipartisan bill marked a rare instance in which Democrats and Republicans largely agreed on a measure involving guns. Democrats have been criticized by the GOP for promoting measures that restrict the flow of guns to the point where they negatively affect law-abiding gun owners.

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'I'm going kicking and screaming'

Women desperately await kidney donors

By Rebecca Johnson
Chicago Tribune

Katie Pappas had kept a secret for weeks from her students at northwest suburban Timber Trails Elementary. The 40-year-old health teacher's kidney was failing, and she spent around eight to 11 hours every night tethered to a dialysis machine.

Eventually, the time came to confide in her students, and she explained that their usually bubbly, upbeat teacher was struggling. Her kindergartners at the Hoffman Estates school didn't understand kidney disease, but they did understand pollution, Pappas said.

"So Miss Pappas' kidney is not cleaning the pollution in



Katie Pappas, left, who is on dialysis and is looking for a kidney donation, joins friends watching the Harvard Milk Days parade on Saturday. AUDREY RICHARDSON/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

her blood, that's why I'm tired all the time. We understand that," Pappas said. "Fourth grade and up, they know the body systems."

Pappas, described by her family and former students as a "giver," "role model" and "inspiration," is one of about 3,500 Illinoisans waiting for a kidney transplant in a state where, according to the American Kidney Fund, the average

wait time is five to seven years.

But Pappas, along with another Chicago mother of four that the Tribune spoke with, may not have that long to wait. They are desperately searching and hoping for their best option, a living donor.

"God, the universe, whatever, has already decided whether I'm getting a kidney or not, and

Turn to Kidneys, Page 4

Iran launches a barrage in retaliation for Israeli strikes

By Jon Gambrell, Josef Federman and Julia Frankel
Associated Press

DUBAI, United Arab Emirates — After Israel launched blistering attacks on the heart of Iran's nuclear and military structure early Friday, deploying warplanes and drones previously smuggled into the country to attack key facilities and kill top generals and scientists, Iran retaliated by unleashing scores of ballistic missiles on Israel late Friday, with explosions flaring in the skies over Jerusalem and Tel Aviv and shaking buildings below.

An Associated Press reporter saw smoke rising in Tel Aviv

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TODAY'S WEATHER



High 76 Low 59

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 8

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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